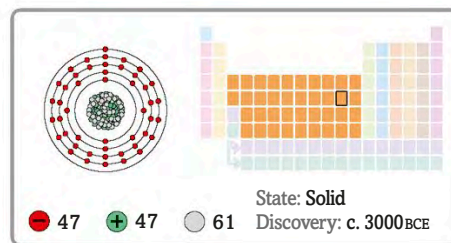


47
Ag

Silver



Forms

This mineral's colour changes to purple when it is exposed to bright light.



1 g (0.03 oz) of silver can be drawn into a **2-km- (1.2-mile-) long** wire.

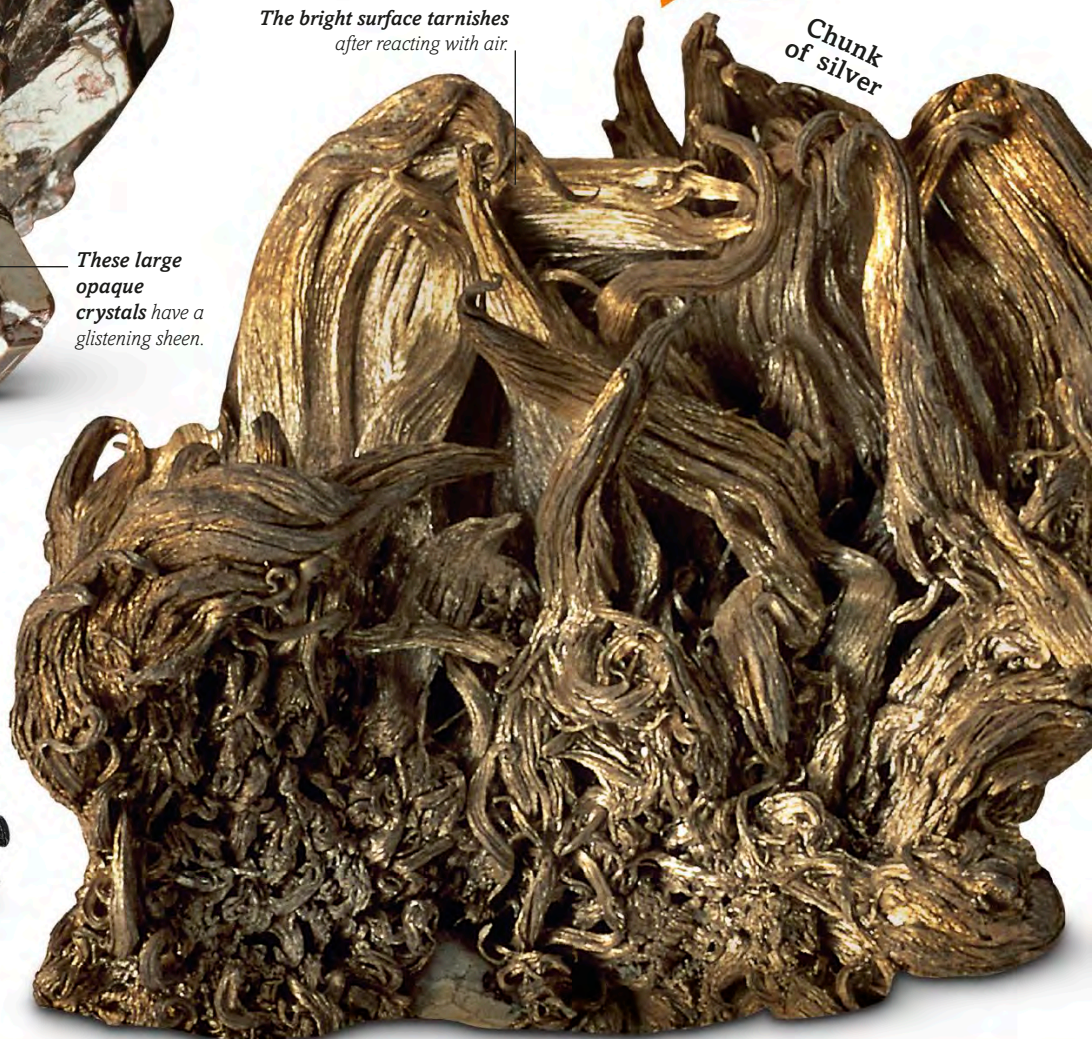
The bright surface tarnishes after reacting with air.



These large opaque crystals have a glistening sheen.



Black silver sulfide forms twisted crystals.



Silver gets its symbol “Ag” from its Latin name *argentum*, which means “shiny white”.

It is considered a precious metal because its pure form has a grey shine that does not corrode quickly, and it stays untarnished if cleaned regularly. Silver can be found pure in

nature, but mostly it is mined from ores, such as **pyrargyrite** and **acanthite**. Because this element is valuable and can be moulded easily, pure silver was used historically to make **coins**. This metal is also ideal for making **bracelets** and settings for gems. Some people even use